

THE DAILY FINANCE BRIEF

Financial News in Plain English

Thursday, July 30, 2026

Edition No. 20

Personalised for Rishabh Srinivasan

ECONOMY

Federal Reserve Keeps Interest Rates Steady to Combat Inflation

On July 29, 2026, the Federal Reserve (the U.S. central bank that controls interest rates) decided to keep its benchmark interest rate unchanged at 3.50%-3.75%. This decision comes as inflation (the general rise in prices of goods and services over time) continues to be a concern, driven by rising oil prices and tensions in the Middle East.

The Fed is closely monitoring economic indicators to ensure maximum employment and stable prices.

This decision is significant for everyday people because interest rates affect how much we pay for loans, mortgages, and credit cards. Keeping rates steady may help maintain more affordable borrowing costs for consumers.

Source: Livemint

MARKETS

Rising Inflation and Tech Investments Cause Stock Market Decline

The Nasdaq Composite, a stock market index that includes many technology companies, fell significantly last week, losing 745.05 points or 2.90%. This decline was mainly due to investor worries about rising inflation and the sustainability of heavy investments in artificial intelligence (AI) by major tech firms. Companies like Sandisk and Intel saw their stock prices drop despite reporting strong earnings.

This market decline is important for everyday people because it can affect retirement savings and investment portfolios. When stock prices fall, it can lead to lower returns for investors, impacting their financial future.

Source: Goodreturns

Market Warning Signs Increase Amid Tech and Inflation Concerns

Investors are becoming more cautious as several warning signs in the market approach critical levels. Concerns are rising over high oil prices, geopolitical tensions, and the sustainability of large investments in artificial intelligence (AI) by major technology companies. These factors have contributed to increased market volatility, raising questions about the stability of investments.

This situation is important for everyday people because it can affect the value of their investments and retirement savings, making it essential to stay informed about market trends.

Source: Investing.com

Oil Prices Surge Above \$100 Due to Middle East Conflicts

Recent conflicts in the Middle East have led to significant disruptions in oil supply chains, causing oil prices to rise above \$100 per barrel. This increase raises concerns about inflation (the general rise in prices of goods and services over time) and its potential impact on global economic growth. Investors are closely watching this situation, as prolonged high energy costs could influence central bank policies and market stability.

This surge in oil prices is important for everyday people because it can lead to higher gas prices and increased costs for goods, affecting household budgets.

Source: *Investing.com*

COMPANIES

Microsoft and Meta Report Earnings Amid Concerns Over AI Spending

On July 29, 2026, Microsoft and Meta Platforms announced their quarterly earnings, revealing that they spent over \$300 billion this year on artificial intelligence (AI) projects. While both companies reported strong revenue growth, investors are worried about whether these large investments will be profitable in the long run. This scrutiny has led to increased market volatility, especially in the tech sector.

This situation is relevant to everyday people because the performance of major companies like Microsoft and Meta can influence stock prices and investment returns, affecting people's financial health.

Source: *Pomegra News*

Apple and Amazon to Release Earnings Reports Amid Market Uncertainty

Apple and Amazon are set to announce their quarterly earnings on July 30, 2026. Investors are paying close attention to these reports due to the companies' significant investments in artificial intelligence (AI) and other emerging technologies. The outcomes of these earnings reports could influence market trends, especially in the technology sector, which has recently experienced increased volatility.

This is relevant for everyday people because the performance of these major companies can affect stock prices and investment returns, impacting individual financial health.

Source: *FX Leaders*

Understanding Capital Expenditure (CapEx) and Its Importance

Capital expenditure, or CapEx, refers to the funds that a company uses to acquire, upgrade, or maintain physical assets such as property, buildings, technology, or equipment. This concept is in the news today due to significant investments by major technology companies like Microsoft and Meta in artificial intelligence (AI) infrastructure. Understanding CapEx is important because it can impact a company's long-term operational efficiency and profitability.

For everyday people, knowing about CapEx helps in understanding how companies invest in their future, which can affect stock prices and investment returns.

Source: *Pomegra News*

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